

Who should our cold emails come from?

A one-page decision on the sender identity (from-name + signature) before we go live. Prepared for Theodore · 2026-06-27

The problem to fix. Today every email signs "Theodore Baird," but each mailbox in Instantly carries its own from-name — so a prospect can see one name in the From line and a different one in the signature. Before we send at volume we need **one coherent identity** (from-name = signature). The right answer depends less on email mechanics and more on **who actually owns the conversation** once a prospect replies.

THE HAND-OFF THIS HAS TO FIT



Theodore is involved (some presentations and calls) but is **not the day-to-day point of contact**. That is the key fact: the name on the email should belong to someone who can own the reply — or to a dedicated outreach persona whose whole job is starting conversations and handing them to Lelia.

THE OPTIONS — SHORT-TERM EFFORT VS LONG-TERM GROWTH

OPTION	SHORT-TERM EFFORT	LONG-TERM GROWTH
Dedicated outreach persona (Malcolm to start; replies → Lelia) RECOMMENDED	Low. One operator (Malcolm) owns the inbox and hands warm replies to Lelia. From-name = signature, set once.	Best. Scales by adding personas as volume grows. Never burns a partner's personal name. The sender's only job is starting conversations.
From "David" (the first-call person)	Medium. David must field early replies himself or route them.	Good rapport (prospect meets the name they emailed), but David's reply load grows with volume — a bottleneck at scale.
From "Theodore" (founder authority)	Low to set up, but every reply lands on you — and you are not the point of contact.	Founder name can lift opens, but creates a hand-off gap and does not scale (you can't field thousands of replies).
Rotating real personas (several names per brand)	Highest. Multiple inboxes, names, and signatures to coordinate.	Most natural and best deliverability spread — the right end-state once volume is high, not the right start.

★ Recommendation

Send + sign as one dedicated outreach persona per brand — Malcolm to start.

- Every mailbox's from-name and signature align to that one persona. No mismatch.
- Positive replies route to **Lelia** to schedule, then into the normal David → Eric flow.
- Keeps your name and your partners' names out of the cold inbox, where reply volume would overwhelm them.

Why this and not your name: you said it yourself — you're involved but not the contact. A founder-signed blast that you can't reply to creates a gap the moment someone responds. A dedicated persona is built to own that reply and hand it off cleanly.

The growth path: start with one persona per brand; add a second and third (the "rotating personas" model) once weekly volume passes a few thousand. Same system, just more faces.

What I need from you: pick the model (recommendation: dedicated persona, Malcolm to start) and confirm the persona name(s) per brand. I align every mailbox's from-name + signature, wire replies to Lelia, and lock it before the first send. If you'd rather it be David, or a name other than Malcolm, just say so — the setup is identical.